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⚡ Overview

⚡Project Odin Guidelines⚡

Last updated: Oct 22, 2026 (see changelog for recent changes)

Welcome to Project Odin!!

Project Odin is an exciting initiative at the frontier of AI development. The goal is to capture realistic, professional macOS workflows to help train and evaluate AI systems. The recordings show how professionals use applications, menus, and system features to complete meaningful work.

These recordings help train and evaluate AI systems by showing **how real users interact with applications, menus, and macOS system behaviors**.

Your Role

Plan and record a task within your approved domain of expertise. Use professional judgment, narrate your decisions, and produce a complete final deliverable.

During each task, you will:

- Plan and prepare the task
- Record and narrate the workflow
- Validate and upload the required files

Change Log

Changes in the last 14 days:	
Oct 19, 2026:	3 apps are suggested but not required. Goal document should be closed or minimized after intro. Reimbursements considered on a case by case basis. Chrome profile setup replaced with Firefox. For setup, technical, contract or pay questions, tag @Maven in #odin--helpdesk. For task ideas, tag @Maven in #odin--ideation. You no longer need a separate recorder account - you may use any account so long as the recording is free of any PII or copyrighted material. **NEW - Epilogue narration requirements:** All task ideas originally approved at or after **Oct 19, 2026 6PM PT** must include an epilogue narration (target: 3-4 mins; maximum: 4:00; longer epilogues may be sent back) which serves as a brief reflection of the work. See here for more details Writer recording guidance remains 15:00 to 50:59 total, including intro and epilogue. Reviewers may accept recordings up to 54:59; this acceptance tolerance does not raise the writer planning target.
Oct 17, 2026:	Captioned narration GIFs added to five Golden Examples. Only Major AutoQC flags block submission; Minor flags are advice. An approved idea continues in the same Studio task. Insightful note added for promoted reviewers who write tasks.
Oct 8, 2026:	**Task Idea** section updated to reflect migration of Task Idea from Odin Dashboard to Mercor Studio.
Oct 3, 2026:	**Idea Approval and Task Creation process update.** Once an Idea is approved, the task you proposed it in moves to In Progress; continue in that same task. Follow the steps in the Task Ideation and Studio Workflow pages to start your task.

Sep 29, 2026: **Complete guide refresh**

Tasks follow the guidelines in effect when they are submitted. A small one-or-two

Tasks follow the guidelines in effect when they are submitted. A small one- or two-hour allowance applies only to recordings already underway when guidance changes, not to submitted tasks.

Changes are announced in #odin--announcements and logged in the Changelog.

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🎯 Expectations

Expectations

Weekly Activity

Target Goal: While not a hard requirement, the general expectation is to aim for **ONE task per day** once onboarding is complete. Please complete onboarding as quickly as possible.

System Requirements

TaskRecorder - You need a Mac running macOS 15 or newer. Apple M-series Macs use TaskRecorder2.4.4.dmg; Intel Macs use TaskRecorder2.4.4-Intel.dmg (both from Important Links).

Complete Onboarding (*This can take a little time)

1. Confirm that you have a Mac running macOS 15 or newer. Apple silicon Macs use TaskRecorder2.4.4.dmg; Intel Macs use TaskRecorder2.4.4-Intel.dmg.
2. Sign in to Okta with the personal email linked to your Mercor account.
3. Open your @mercor.expert account from the Google Workspace tile in Okta.
4. Use @mercor.expert for Studio and every Odin Document.
5. Log in to RL Studio through your Mercor My Apps dashboard
6. Run Insightful for active hourly-paid Odin work. Do not run it for eligible tasks retaining old per-task terms (Pay FAQ Q9). The first onboarding task follows fixed milestone pay after the 3 paid setup hours.
7. Set up your Mac: Workpuls/Insightful, Accessibility Inspector, and TaskRecorder 2.4.4; a separate Recorder user is optional (See Technical Setup).
8. In Slack, open the #odin--new-onboarders and follow the pinned Start here post.

Required Tools

Tool	Purpose
Okta	Accessing Google Workspace and Slack
Insightful	Tracking project activity
Slack	Project communication and support
Odin Dashboard	Contains personalized payout information
Studio	Onboarding, Idea proposal and Submitting tasks
TaskRecorder	Recording tasks
Accessibility Inspector	Helps Task Recorder capture all required metadata
Maven	Ask @Maven in #odin--helpdesk

Before You Begin

Read all sections of this guide, then open Studio → Project Odin → Odin Production Full Workflow → + Create Task and follow the onboarding steps in the task. Check the

latest & pinned messages in the Slack channels. If you encounter a problem, use the Technical Issues and Contacts tabs for support.

Task Domains

You will record your computer screen while completing professional tasks across several domains, narrating what you are doing and why. No webcam or filming yourself is required.

Abbreviation	Category / Department
ARCH	Architecture
AUD	Audio & Music Production
BUSI	Consulting & Business Operations; Product Management
DES	Design (Graphic / UX / UI)
DSD	Data Science & Analytics; Software & AI/ML Engineering
EDU	Education
ENG	Engineering (Non-Software)
FIN	Finance
GTM	Marketing; Sales & Biz Dev
HLS	Healthcare & Life Sciences
HR	HR & People Ops
IMG	Photography
IT	IT Support
LAW	Legal
RNA	Research & Academia
TEXT	Content & Writing
VFX	Animation & VFX
VID	Video

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💰 Payments

Payments

How Payment Works

Your current contract sets your base hourly pay. Writer adds a 37.5% tier bonus and Super Writer adds 87.5% of that base. Approval in the progression rules below means Ready for Delivery (RFD). See the Pay FAQ for detailed rules and exceptions.

Video walkthrough (4.5 minutes): Odin writer pay - New hourly model.mp4

Presentation slides: Odin writer pay | New hourly model

Pay, progression and work limits:

- **Initial onboarding, setup and first task:** Up to 3 paid setup hours in total at your contract's base rate. The first task itself is not paid hourly. If you have not received any onboarding or first-task bonuses, your first new task under the updated terms earns $150 once on submission and $250 once when that same task reaches RFD, even if you have earlier Review Approved tasks. For writers in Onboarding, the first task's RFD unlocks Trial.
  - **Ran out of your 3 onboarding hours?** You can still finish your first task to unlock the submission and RFD bonuses. Hitting the 3-hour cap doesn't stop you from earning either one.
- **Trial–task 2, 3, and 4**: Work at your base hourly rate, starting with 12 hours on Insightful. Each approved task adds 3 hours. After 3 Trial tasks reach RFD, enter Production as a Writer. Rejected tasks do not count toward these 3 approvals. Up to 3 open tasks. If your Trial allowance reaches 0 hours, finish the current task without further hourly pay until it reaches RFD and unlocks 3 more paid hours. Time worked while the balance is exhausted is not paid hourly; discretionary top-ups are not available. If the balance is incorrect or earned hours are missing, pause hourly-paid work and contact Maven.
- **Production–if your base is $40/hour:** Throttled Writer $40/hour, up to 40 hours/week and 3 open tasks; Writer $55/hour, up to 60 hours/week and 5 open tasks; Super Writer $75/hour, up to 80 hours/week and 10 open tasks. Higher bases scale proportionally. These are firm weekly limits. Stop work at your cap; additional hours or exceptions are not available. Tasks awaiting approval count as open; rejected tasks are closed.
- **Tier reviews:** Efficiency means approved video produced for the hours worked, assessed regularly. A warning keeps your current pay while you have time to recover; your tier may then change if efficiency has not recovered. Persistently very low efficiency may lead to removal. Unfinished tasks count toward assessment only once approved or rejected. Tier assessment uses several metrics, primarily the time needed to deliver RFD tasks.

Starting tier for new writers: If you receive your first Odin contract on or after October 21, 2026 at 12:00 a.m. Pacific, you do not need to check the lookup table. You start in Onboarding and move to Trial after your first task reaches Ready for Delivery (RFD).

Starting tier for existing writers: Check the starting-tier lookup table with your mercor.expert Google account. It is a snapshot of your starting placement. The Odin Pay Dashboard is being updated for hourly pay; we'll confirm when the updated pay information is available. See FAQ Q4.

information is available. See FAQ Q4.

Reviewer, QC and support pay

Effective 3:00 p.m. Pacific (PDT) on October 22, 2026. The rates below are total hourly compensation in USD.

Role	Tier	Total (USD/hour)
Reviewer	Standard	$55
Reviewer	Trusted	$75
QC	Standard	$75
QC	Trusted	$80
Support	Specialist	$50
Support	Senior Specialist	$60
Support	Lead	$75

These replace the corresponding role/tier hourly totals from this effective time. Hours before and after the cutoff use the rate applicable when the work was done. The writer pay terms, amendment deadlines and existing-work dates in this guide are unchanged.

Contract base and role bonuses: Standard Reviewer $55 base; Trusted Reviewer $55 base + $20/hour tier bonus. Standard QC $75 base; Trusted QC $75 base + $5/hour tier bonus. Support Specialist $50 base; Senior Support Specialist $50 base + $10/hour role bonus; Support Lead $50 base + $25/hour role bonus. Contracts show the base, with the amount above it paid as a bonus. A published rate does not confirm that an individual's contract update or tier assignment has completed.

Support live hosting: the separate $15 bonus per verified live hosting hour began October 22, 2026 at 12:00 a.m. Pacific, replacing the previous $10 bonus. The support role rates above take effect at 3:00 p.m. PDT; from then, total hosted-hour pay is $65 for Support Specialists, $75 for Senior Support Specialists and $90 for Support Leads. For earlier hours, use the role rate in effect when the work was done plus the $15 hosting bonus.

The writer starting-tier lookup does not identify reviewer, QC or support tiers. If your assignment or contract is unclear, ask in your role's pay-announcement thread. Separately announced incentives keep their own eligibility, qualifying windows and payout terms.

General Payment Info

- **Amendment acceptance:** All Odin writers must accept the new hourly-pay amendment within 48 hours of receiving it. Writers who were already hourly must receive and accept their amendment to reactivate before resuming hourly work. Task-paid writers may continue under their existing terms while the amendment is pending. If you decline or miss the deadline, your Odin contract is paused. Contact Maven in #odin--helpdesk to request the amendment again. See the amendment FAQ.
- **Starting placement:** Existing writers with no past RFD approvals start in Onboarding; those with at least one start as Writer. Super Writer also requires verified qualifying performance. New writers follow the Onboarding and Trial progression above. See FAQ Q12.
- **Existing work:** Tasks that had reached Idea Approved: Start Recording or a later review stage by 12:00 a.m. Pacific on Wednesday, October 21, 2026 retain the prior agreed rate and applicable bonuses if the completed task and video are submitted using Submit for Review by 11:59 p.m. Pacific on Friday, October 23, 2026. Do not run Insightful for these tasks. See FAQ Q9.
- **Existing offers:** Previously promised bonuses retain their original rules and qualifying dates; expired offers do not reopen. There is no regular per-task bonus. Any extra incentive pay is announced in advance.
- **Eligible hours:** For hourly-paid work, base pay and any applicable tier bonus cover

active project time recorded in Insightful, within your applicable stage allowance or weekly limit. Extra hours above the limit are not payable; see FAQ Q18 for the distinct Trial, Production and tracking-error rules. Task approval is not required. Idle or off-project time is not payable. See FAQ Q1 and Q3.

- **Tracking limits: At a genuine 0-hour Trial balance, finish the current task without further hourly pay until RFD unlocks more paid hours. In Production, stop work at your weekly cap; no extra hours or exceptions are available. For a tracking error, incorrect balance or missing earned hours, pause hourly-paid work and tag Maven in #odin--helpdesk with your mercor.expert email, timer details and relevant Studio task link. Eligible old-contract tasks and the first onboarding task after the 3 paid setup hours retain their separate fixed-payment terms. See FAQ Q18.**
- Refer to Mercor's pay policy.

Payment Providers

- **Stripe:** The primary payment platform for ongoing contributors. After accepting a job offer, follow the instructions to create your payout account.
- **Wise:** Generally used for one-time payments, contributors who have not completed Stripe onboarding, or contributors whose bank accounts are in countries Stripe does not support. You don't need a Mercor account to receive payment through Wise. Follow the instructions to set up Wise.

Payment Timing

- **First payout:** Verification may add 3-5 business days.
- **Hourly pay:** Sent every Wednesday for the previous Saturday-to-Friday week, counted in India Standard Time (IST). Payments for tasks that retain the old per-task terms follow the regular payment schedule. See FAQ Q17.
- **Tier bonuses:** Normally paid the Wednesday after the corresponding hourly pay, but may arrive earlier, including with that payment.
- **Missing pay:** If an expected payment or bonus has not arrived after two pay cycles, submit the payment query form. We will respond within 2 business days. See FAQ Q17.
- **Possible delays:** Bank holidays, processing schedules, and bank cutoffs may delay settlements.

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Pay FAQ

Odin Writer Pay FAQ

Jump to: 1. Pay and tiers | 2. Your contract and the switch to hourly pay | 3. Tasks already in progress | 4. Hours and time tracking | 5. Payments and missing pay | 6. Getting help

1. Pay and tiers

Q1: My contract says $40/hour. Is that right?

Yes. Your contract shows your **base hourly rate**, e.g. $40/hour, before any writer tier bonus is added. Your tier determines the bonus pay you receive on top of that base:

- **Writer:** an additional 37.5%. With a $40/hour base, that's $15 extra per hour, bringing your total to **$55/hour**.
- **Super Writer:** an additional 87.5%. With a $40/hour base, that's $35 extra per hour, bringing your total to **$75/hour**.

Bonus pay is issued once a week and applies to eligible hours at your applicable tier: hours within your applicable stage allowance or weekly limit. Extra hours above the limit are not payable; see Q18 for the stage-specific rules. Task approval is not required for those hours to qualify. Idle or off-project time does not qualify for base pay or tier bonuses. This structure also applies if your previous contract showed a higher rate.

Tiers are reviewed regularly. Paying the extra amount as a bonus lets us adjust your pay without sending you a new contract each time.

Q2: How is my efficiency calculated, and what do I need for each pay tier?

Efficiency is calculated by various metrics, but primarily derived from how many hours it takes for you to work to deliver usable tasks (defined as tasks in *Ready for Delivery)*. The Odin Pay Dashboard is being updated for hourly pay. For now, check the starting-tier lookup table (see Q4).

Tiers are reviewed regularly. You'll receive a warning and time to improve before any tier reduction.

Q3: Will I earn less under the hourly model?

We believe the new model will work to your benefit! Earnings will depend on your tier and the eligible hours you work, so they may differ from your previous contract. Under the hourly model, you're paid for **eligible time recorded in Insightful within your applicable stage allowance or weekly limit, including edits, send-backs and work on tasks that don't get approved. Extra hours above the limit are not payable; see Q18 for what to do when hours run out. A task does not need to reach *Ready for Delivery* for that time to be paid.**

Up to **3 setup hours in total** are paid at your base rate. Your first eligible new task under the updated terms earns $150 once on submission and $250 once when that same task reaches Ready for Delivery (RFD), if you have not received any onboarding or first-task bonuses. Earlier Review Approved tasks do not exclude you. The task itself is not hourly-paid. For writers in Onboarding, the first task's RFD unlocks Trial.

Q4: Where can I see my tier and pay, and why does my earnings page show $0?

You can find your starting tier in the writer starting-tier lookup table shared in our announcement. Open it with your mercor.expert Google account and search for your expert email. The table is a snapshot of your starting tier. If your entry is missing or looks incorrect, tag Maven in #odin--helpdesk with your mercor.expert email and a relevant Studio task link so we can check.

We're updating the *Odin Pay Dashboard* for the move to hourly pay, so a $0 figure may not yet reflect your earnings. We'll confirm when the updated pay information is available.

2. Your contract and the switch to hourly pay

Q5: Do writers have to accept the new pay amendment?

Yes. All Odin writers must move to the new hourly-pay model. You have **48 hours from receiving your amendment** to accept it. If you decline or miss the deadline, your Odin contract will be paused.

If you are paused for this reason, contact Maven in #odin--helpdesk to request that the amendment be sent again.

Q6: I haven't received my amended contract yet. What should I do?

Most writers should have received their amended contract by now. If you haven't, please let Maven know in #odin--helpdesk and we'll make sure you receive yours as soon as possible. Writers who were hourly prior to amendments must wait for their amendment and accept to reactivate. Task-paid writers can continue work until their amendment arrives. You have **48 hours from the time you receive it** to accept it.

Q7: I declined my amendment by mistake. What now?

Post in #odin--helpdesk with your mercor.expert email and say you declined by mistake. We'll send you the amendment again.

Q8: I was offboarded. Why did I get a new contract?

It was sent by mistake. You don't need to accept anything. If you accept the contract, you can ask Maven to be offboarded.

3. Tasks already in progress

Q9: I started a task during the pay per task model, how will I get paid upon task approval?

If your task had already reached *Idea Approved: Start Recording* in Studio by **12:00 a.m. Pacific on Wednesday, October 21**, we will:

- Honor the prior agreed rate and any applicable bonuses, provided that you submit your completed task and video using *Submit for Review* by **11:59 p.m. Pacific on Friday, October 23**.
- This also applies if your task had already moved to a later review stage by the cutoff.
- For these tasks, **do not run your Insightful timer**.

This should cover all of the following cases:

- Tasks that were in progress and will be submitted for the first time
- Tasks already submitted and not yet reviewed
- Tasks reviewed, pending edits

Note: Submit your completed task and video using Submit for Review by **11:59 p.m. Pacific on Friday, October 23**.

Q10: My task was submitted a while ago and is still not reviewed.

We are aware of delays in the review process that are delaying signoff. The project team is currently implementing initiatives to dramatically improve turnaround time at the review layer. Thank you for your patience as we transition to a more scalable model.

4. Hours and time tracking

Q11: Why does my timer have a limit, and how do I get more hours?

It depends on your stage:

- **Onboarding:** up to **3 paid setup hours in total**. This allowance does not renew weekly. You can keep working on your first task after that. Your first task pay follows a fixed non-hourly schedule: $150 when you submit it and another $250 when it reaches Ready for Delivery, the final approval step.
- **Trial: 12 hours as a starting allowance. Each task that reaches Ready for Delivery automatically adds 3 hours to your Insightful timer. After 3 Trial tasks reach RFD, you move to Production as a Writer. Rejected tasks do not count toward these 3 approvals. If the allowance reaches 0 hours first, finish the current task without further hourly pay until RFD unlocks more paid hours. Time worked while the balance is exhausted is not paid hourly; discretionary top-ups are not available. For a balance or tracking error, pause hourly-paid work and ask Maven to check it.**
- **Production: up to 40 hours a week as a Throttled Writer, 60 as a Writer and 80 as a Super Writer. These are firm weekly limits. Stop work at your cap; additional hours or exceptions are not available.**

If your limit looks wrong for your stage, ask Maven in #odin--helpdesk. For installation, sign-in and timer instructions, see **Insightful timer Setup** below.

Q12: My task is Review Approved, but I'm listed as Onboarding with a 3-hour limit.

Review Approved is not the same as Ready for Delivery (RFD). Some Review Approved tasks receive a final QC check before reaching RFD. For starting placement under the amendment, existing writers with no past RFD approvals start in Onboarding; those with at least one start as Writer. Super Writer also requires verified qualifying performance. New writers who receive their first Odin contract on or after October 21, 2026 at 12:00 a.m. Pacific start in Onboarding.

Check your starting placement in the starting-tier lookup table using your mercor.expert Google account.

If your starting tier or hour limit appears inconsistent with your past RFD approvals, please tag Maven in #odin--helpdesk with your mercor.expert email and the relevant Studio task link so we can check your assignment.

Q13: My Insightful hours reset to 0 after accepting the amendment, or my hour limit hasn't increased when expected. What should I do?

We're looking into these issues. In the meantime, please **tag Maven in #odin--helpdesk** with your **mercor.expert email** and a brief description of what happened. The team will pick it up from there, check your account and correct your hour limit where needed.

Q14: I was at 10 hours worked this week and my timer dropped to 3 hours and I can't work. What should I do?

If your hour limit looks incorrect, please tag Maven in #odin--helpdesk with your mercor.expert email and a brief description of the issue so the team can check your account.

4.1 Insightful timer setup

Q15: How do I get started?

You don't need to wait for an invite email. Download the Insightful desktop app (Windows 10+ or macOS 11+) and sign in with Continue with SSO using your @mercor.expert email. For hourly-paid work, choose Project Odin, press Play when you start working, and Stop when you finish or take a break. Full setup guide: Using Insightful

Q16: What counts as billable time, and how much can I log?

Log only active project work: tasks, project meetings, and project-related training. You can check your weekly cap on your contract tab, and hours above your applicable allowance or cap are not paid. Production limits are firm with no additional hours or exceptions; see Q18 for the Trial and tracking-error rules. Mercor reviews logs every week, and idle or off-project time may be removed before payout. Details: Time Tracking & Pay

5. Payments and missing pay

Q17: When will I be paid?

Payments for tasks that retain the old per-task terms follow the regular payment schedule. Under the hourly model:

1. Hourly pay is sent every Wednesday for the previous week (Saturday to Friday, India time).
2. Tier bonuses are normally paid the Wednesday after the corresponding hourly pay, but may arrive earlier, including with the hourly payment. Tier bonuses are the amount paid above the base hourly rate in your contract.

The *Odin Pay Dashboard* is being updated for hourly pay. Once the updated information is available, it will show what has been paid and what is still planned for payment (see Q4).

If there are any issues and your expected payment or bonuses have not been received after two pay cycles, please fill out this form (only accessible via @mercor.expert email). We will respond within 2 business days.

Q18: When do I get paid, and what if something looks wrong?

Hourly pay goes out every Wednesday for the previous Saturday–Friday week, counted in IST.

If your Trial allowance genuinely reaches 0 hours, finish the current task without further hourly pay until it reaches RFD and unlocks 3 more paid hours. Time worked while the balance is exhausted is not paid hourly; discretionary top-ups are not available. In Production, stop work at your firm weekly cap (40/60/80 hours for Throttled Writer/Writer/Super Writer); no additional hours or exceptions are available. If Insightful has a tracking error, an incorrect balance or missing earned hours, pause hourly-paid work and tag Maven in #odin--helpdesk with your mercor.expert email, timer details and relevant Studio task link.

You may continue eligible tasks under the old per-task terms and your first onboarding task after the 3 paid setup hours. That work follows its fixed payment terms and **does not earn additional hourly pay**.

To dispute hours that were removed, see Disputes.

6. Getting help

Q19: Where can I ask questions?

Tag @Maven in #odin--helpdesk for setup, contract and pay questions, in #odin--ideation for task ideas, or in #odin-reviewers-hub if you're a reviewer. Maven doesn't answer in #odin--announcements.

Q20: I was moved to reviewer by mistake, or I want to see reviewer pay before accepting.

Effective 3:00 p.m. Pacific (PDT) on October 22, 2026, Standard Reviewers receive $55/hour base pay and Trusted Reviewers receive $55/hour base + $20/hour tier bonus = $75/hour total (USD). A contract may show only the base rate; an individual's tier assignment and contract update still need to be confirmed separately. See the non-writer rate summary in Payments for reviewer, QC and support rates. If you think your reviewer assignment is a mistake, post in #odin-reviewers-hub so the team can check it. For a voluntary move to a different role, use the form in Q21. Continue your assigned duties until the team confirms a change.

Q21: Can reviewers, QC specialists or auditors write tasks or request a role change?

No. Reviewers, QC specialists and auditors should focus on their assigned duties and should not write tasks alongside their current role, including when their queue is empty.

To request a move to a lower role, submit the Odin Role Change Request form. Reviewers can request Writer; QC specialists and auditors can request Reviewer or Writer. This form does not accept promotion requests. Writer promotions are handled automatically based on performance.

Continue in your current role until the team approves the change and confirms your start date, pay/contract terms, access and handling of unfinished tasks.

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🔗 Important Links

Important Links

Use your Mercor expert account (@mercor.expert) to open every link on this page. You will **not** have access if you're signed in with your personal email. If a link asks you to request access, switch to your @mercor.expert account and try again.

Quick reference: Odin Writer Cheat Sheet (PDF)

Tools

1. RLStudio: Mercor My Apps dashboard
2. TaskRecorder:
3. TaskRecorder2.4.4.dmg **(Apple Silicon M-series Macs only)**
4. TaskRecorder2.4.4-Intel.dmg **(Intel Mac users)**
5. Slack
6. **Project Odin Announcement Channel: #odin--announcements**
7. Use TaskRecorder2.4.4.dmg from the download above. TaskRecorder2.4.3.dmg and earlier installers are obsolete. Quit every running copy (⌘Q), install in Applications and choose Replace, then reopen from Applications. Remove obsolete app copies and old DMGs, but keep all recordings and exports. TaskRecorder 2.4.4 needs no OTA or Google sign-in; task-app login rules still apply.
8. Odin Dashboard

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Ready to start?
Create a task in Odin Production Full Workflow.

+ Create task

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OVERVIEW

Time Tracking (Insightful)

Time Tracking (Insightful)

For hourly-paid work, run Insightful during active Odin work within your applicable stage allowance or weekly limit. Extra hours above the limit are not payable. Pause it for breaks, idle time and off-project activity. Do not run it for eligible tasks retaining old per-task terms (Pay FAQ Q9). Your first onboarding task follows fixed milestone pay after the 3 paid setup hours.

Warning: Waiting for Maven or another LLM to generate ideas does not qualify as project work. Pause Insightful while you wait, and resume it when you're actively working again.

Log time when you actually perform the work

✅Valid project work: log in Insightful	❌Not project work: do not log in Insightful
Reading and completing the Mercor onboarding guide	Sitting idle or waiting for new tasks
Reading and completing this project's Instructions Doc	Watching Slack in case something is posted
Attending or watching kickoff calls	Chit-chatting with other experts in Slack
Attending or watching office hours	Waiting for access to project task tooling
Working on your tasks	Resolving non-blocking personal technical issues
Reviewing other contributors' tasks (if assigned reviewer)	Work done for a different vendor that also uses Insightful
Actively participating in or posting in necessary Slack discussions	Time spent on social media or unrelated sites
Preparing files and apps, recording, validating, uploading and submitting tasks	Waiting for Maven or another LLM to generate task ideas

Using the timer

- Download the Insightful desktop app and sign in with Continue with SSO using your @mercor.expert email. Full guide: Using Insightful.
- Choose Project Odin and press Play when you start project work.
- Press Stop when you finish, take a break, or switch to anything that isn't project work.
- For hourly-paid recording, keep Insightful running in the background or minimized. Don't show its window on screen (see Restricted App List).

Note

Mercor reviews Insightful logs every week. Idle or off-project time may be removed before payout. For hour limits by stage, see the Pay FAQ. At a genuine 0-hour Trial balance, finish the current task without further hourly pay until RFD unlocks more paid hours; discretionary top-ups are not available. In Production, stop work at your firm weekly cap; no additional hours or exceptions are available. For a tracking error, incorrect balance or missing earned hours, pause hourly-paid work and tag @Maven

in #odin--helpdesk with your mercor.expert email, timer details and relevant Studio task link.

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